



Mary Star ^{OF} the Sea
Elementary & Middle School

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Intermediate Team Faculty

Mary, Star of the Sea School

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Syllabus: 2026-2027 Grade 4 English

Welcome to Grade 4. This syllabus is intended to help you, the student, develop a greater understanding of what we will cover, what is expected of you, and what you can expect from me. For English, my primary focus will be to complete this year with all students developing a love for, and a grade-level understanding of, books, writing, language, and grammar.

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission Statement:

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question: TBD

Course Overview:

English: *This course focuses on developing reading, writing, speaking, and listening skills. Students will engage with classic and modern literature, explore grammar and vocabulary, and practice various forms of writing.*

CLASS NOVELS:

This school year, students will read four core novels as a class, along with supplemental materials to be provided. Some are classic novels that parents might recognize; others are likely unfamiliar. The novels will be provided by the school, unless otherwise specified, at a later time. The 4th-grade core novels include the following:

Wonder by R.J. Palacio

The Tale of Despereaux, also by Kate DiCamillo

Inside Out and Back Again by Thanhha Lai

Holes by Louis Sachar

WRITING UNITS:

Beyond regular daily journal writing, students will write quarterly essays and poems. They will be drafted step-by-step. First by hand, and then as Google Doc drafts. All essay writing must be completed at school and be students' only, with teacher help, unless otherwise stated.

Quarter 1: Realistic Fiction Writing

Quarter 2: Informational Writing

Quarter 3: Persuasive Writing

Quarter 4: Poetry and Historical Fiction Writing

READING UNITS::

Q1: Launching into reading workshop and interpreting characters

Q2: Non-fiction reading - Using Text Structures to Comprehend Expository, Narrative and Hybrid Nonfiction

Q3: Detail and synthesis- Close reading of fiction

Q4: Reading history- historical fiction and nonfiction

GRADING POLICY:

English

- 35% Written Work (e.g., journals, reports, projects, etc.)
- 30% Classwork and Guided Practice
- 25% Assessments (Oral/Written Tests and Quizzes)
- 10% Participation and Collaboration

*Parents, please note: You will have access to my electronic grade book via your Beehively account, which will be a primary method of communicating your child's academic performance.

It will be assumed that you have seen all grades and missing assignments that are entered in Beehively.

HOMEWORK POLICY:

Students are expected to read 20 minutes every day. In addition to the reading, other homework will be assigned. Your children's teachers will work together to ensure that students receive a balanced homework regimen that fosters a positive learning environment and nurtures their intellectual growth. Assignments are expected to be written daily in a student's planner and available on Google Calendar. Parents are expected to check the student's planner daily, support their child in time management and follow through. Late work will be accepted; however, late assignments will negatively affect students' participation grades.

CLASSROOM EXPECTATIONS:

- Students are expected to come to class prepared and ready to learn.
- Homework should be completed daily and turned in. If there is a reason the homework cannot be completed on time, the teacher should be notified in advance, and a plan should be made to complete the assignment.
- Students are expected to always try their best and participate in class. Further, they are expected to ask questions, request clarification, and communicate via office hours or email as needed.
- Students are expected to respect themselves, respect others, and respect all property.
- Class Consequences:

Step 1: Verbal Warning

Step 2: Informational Update: Think Paper & Signature (*student-led reflection brought home for parent review*)

Step 3: Direct Parent Contact (*Phone call, email discussion to problem-solve together, or scheduled meeting with principal if needed*)

REQUIRED MATERIALS:

Students should be prepared on a daily basis with the following:

- English composition book
- Core novel
- Erasable pen, pencil, eraser and highlighter
- Glue stick/scissors
- Sticky notes
- Index cards
- Planner

Important Dates:

Orientation: August 12, 2026

Parent-Teacher Conferences: Fall 9/10-11, 2026, Spring 2/19/27 (Optional)

Expeditions:

- Q1 October 2nd, 2026 - Coconut Island
- Q2 November 16th and December 14th, 2026 - Arizona Memorial and Ice Palace
- Q3 March 5th, 2027 'Iolani Palace
- Q4 June 1st, 2027 Niu Valley

(All expedition dates and times are subject to change)

School Spelling Bee: November 20th, 2026

Christmas Performance: December 18th, 2026

End-of-Year Awards: June 3rd, 2027

EMPOWERED TO SUCCEED, GUIDED BY FAITH ❤️!